

Looking at the Ghost game through Scratch goggles

Program flow works the same in most programming languages. Here are some examples of input, processing, and output in Python's Ghost game—and what they might look like in Scratch.

Python and Scratch
are more similar
than they appear.



EXPERT TIPS

One script at a time

There's an important difference between Scratch and Python. In Scratch, lots of scripts can run at the same time. In Python, however, the program is made up of only one script.

1 Input

In Python, the "input()" function takes an input from the keyboard. It's similar to the "ask and wait" block in Scratch.

```
door = input('1, 2 or 3?')
```

The question
appears on screen

ask 1, 2 or 3? and wait

"ask and wait" Scratch block

The question in
the Scratch block

2 Processing

Variables are used to keep track of the score and the function "randint" picks a random door. Different blocks are used to do these things in Scratch.

```
score = 0
```

Sets the variable
"score" to 0

set score ▼ to 0

"set score to 0" Scratch block

This Scratch block
sets the value of the
variable "score" to 0

```
ghost_door = randint(1, 3)
```

Selects a random
whole number
between 1 and 3

pick random 1 to 3

"pick random" Scratch block

This Scratch block
selects a random
number

3 Output

The "print()" function is used to output things in Python, while the "say" block does the same thing in Scratch.

```
print('Ghost game')
```

Displays "Ghost game"
on the screen

say Ghost game

"say" Scratch block

Shows a speech bubble
containing the words
"Ghost game"